



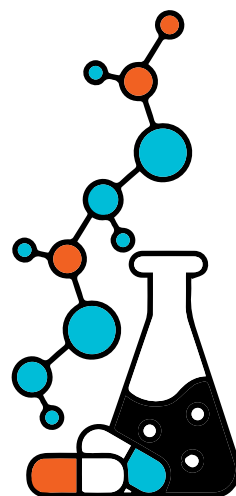
All About the Mind

BREAKING FREE FROM historical stigmas, mental health is all set to take centre stage in 2024. With rising awareness, even the government is committed to the cause: its National Mental Health Mission seeks to address the accessibility and affordability issues around mental well-being. Meanwhile, tech solutions, including teletherapy and mental health apps, are bridging the gap in rural areas. Workplaces, too, are prioritising mental well-being by fostering a supportive work environment. Even as challenges persist, it is clear that there is momentum towards prioritising mental health in the country.

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FORMULA FOR GROWTH

INDIAN PHARMA FIRMS are grappling with maintaining their regulatory compliance and meeting global standards. Stringent requirements in key markets have heightened the need for compliance with good manufacturing practices, strong data integrity monitoring and robust quality control. While compliance is costly, it also offers enhanced brand reputation, broader market access and fosters innovation. Hence, nurturing regulatory excellence will define the trajectory of Indian pharma firms in 2024 and beyond.



Jio Financial's Key Man

Hitesh Kumar Sethia, MD and CEO of Jio Financial Services (JFS), is the driving force behind the Reliance group's foray into financial services. The group has big ambitions under his leadership. A seasoned professional who was with ICICI Bank earlier, Sethia brings a global repertoire of experiences to the table. With stints in Europe, Asia and North America, Sethia has played pivotal roles across verticals like credit, retail and corporate banking, among others, which will help him scale JFS.

PREPARING FOR THE BATTLE

LIFE INSURANCE CORPORATION of India has had a rough 2023, having witnessed a drop in its share of monthly new business premiums (NBP) to 58.50 per cent in September 2023 from 68.25 per cent, a year ago. But Chairperson *Siddhartha Mohanty* is spearheading efforts to bolster LIC's market presence with new products, including guaranteed return products. With an eye on increasing NBP, Mohanty has launched a non-participating product this year, with more in the pipeline. As the insurance giant finds its footing again, investors may need to hold their breath a little longer.

